cdpg | Centre for Digital Public Goods
IIM BANGALORE

TRACK
03
GOVERNANCE & ECOSYSTEM MANAGEMENT

DigiYatra

COMMERCIAL EXPANSION

TEAM VISTAR



TEAM

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We propose a governance framework for DigiYatra's responsible expansion into commercial applications.

DigiYatra Token System

GOVERNANCE & ECOSYSTEM MANAGEMENT

THE CHALLENGE

RISKS IF UNADDRESSED

Loss of public trust
Perceived commercial exploitation may reduce adoption and confidence in DigiYatra.

Consent challenges
Passengers may not be aware of or comfortable with their biometric-linked data being used for commercial purposes.

Unclear accountability
If data is misused, breached or shared without proper consent, it is unclear who is responsible.



OUTCOMES & IMPACT

A MORE TRUSTED AND INCLUSIVE ECOSYSTEM

Data stays protected
Passenger information is never shared beyond DYF and relevant authorities.

Seamless experience
Enables innovative commercial services with a smooth and convenient passenger journey.

Clear oversight and accountability
Defined governance and accountability across participating entities.

Greater public trust
Responsible expansion strengthens trust and enables wider participation in the DigiYatra ecosystem.

DYF = DigiYatra Foundation

Enabling a trusted, open and accountable ecosystem for commercial participation in DigiYatra.

PARTNER JOURNEY (From Interest to Trusted Participation)

1. **Apply & Register** — Meet eligibility criteria and agree to DYF guidelines.
2. **Due Diligence** — Verify credentials and assess compliance with privacy, security and data standards.
3. **Integrate** — Connect via open APIs/standards. Access only the minimum data needed.
4. **Operate** — Serve passengers using purpose-specific tokens under defined rules.
5. **Monitor & Audit** — Continuous oversight by DYF (bookings, payments, data usage).
6. **Renew / Revoke** — Periodic certification. Non-compliance can lead to restriction, suspension or revocation.

Only trusted, compliant organisations can participate.

Innovation grows within a framework of trust.

1 PURPOSE-BOUND ACCESS

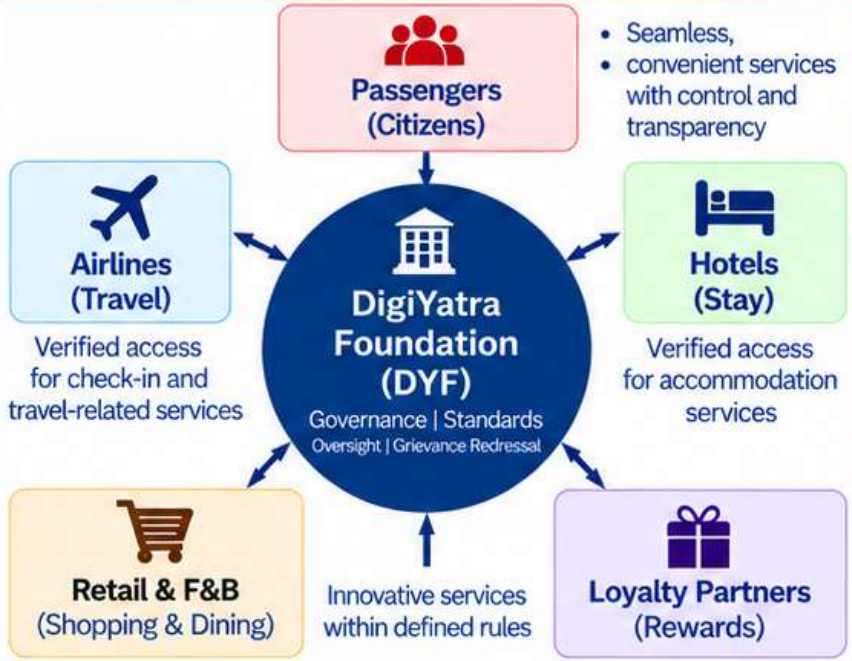
Purpose Limitation & Data Minimisation

- Each service gets a separate token for a specific purpose (e.g. check-in, lounge, retail).
- Only the minimum information required for that service is shared.
- Token becomes void after service completion (no reuse for other purposes).
- No access to full identity (e.g. Aadhaar) or biometric data by commercial partners.

2 OPENNESS OF ECOSYSTEM PARTICIPATION

- **Standardized APIs:** Public, equal access is guaranteed for all qualified businesses.
- **Tiered onboarding:** Security clearance requirements scale based on data risk levels.
- **Transparent vetting:** Partner selection criteria and approval statuses are published openly.

A MULTI-STAKEHOLDER ECOSYSTEM



3 GOVERNANCE AND ACCOUNTABILITY

Regulatory Oversight & Accountability

- DigiYatra Foundation (DYF) as the sole regulatory authority for ecosystem participation.
- Mandatory registration and compliance with privacy, security, consent and accountability standards.
- Ongoing audits of data usage, bookings, payments and token issuance.
- Clear grievance redressal mechanism for citizens.
- Organisations are accountable for their systems (including third-party vendors) and liable for misuse.

4 CITIZEN RIGHTS, ENFORCEMENT AND REVOCATION

Safeguards for a Trusted Ecosystem

- **Data dashboards:** Citizens can see who accessed their data and when.
- **Right to erasure:** Citizens can request deletion of non-essential commercial data.
- **Annual certification:** Regular audits to ensure compliance.
- **Risk-based enforcement:** Warning → Restriction → Suspension → Revocation.
- **Automatic disconnection:** Tokens and API access are disabled if rules are violated.
- **Clear legal recourse:** Simple mechanism to raise complaints and claim damages for misuse.

Citizen Control & Interoperability

One consent. Many services. Always under the citizen's control.

1 CITIZEN CONTROL JOURNEY

End-to-end view of how a citizen controls their data in DigiYatra's commercial use cases.

1. Choose Service	2. Review & Give Consent	3. Data Stays with DYF	4. Use Service	5. Manage Anytime
e.g. Airport lounge, retail offer, loyalty enrolment.	See what data will be shared, purpose and duration.	Passenger data is not shared directly with third parties. DYF shares only the required verification token/response.	Seamless experience with verified access (e.g. lounge entry).	View, edit, withdraw consent or request deletion.

You stay in control – before, during and after.

2 CITIZEN RIGHTS : 'MERA DATA, MERA ADHIKAAR'

Clear, usable rights for every citizen.

Right	What it means	Citizen can...
Visibility	See what data is accessed, when, why and with whom.	• View access logs • See purpose and partner name
Erasure	Request deletion of non-essential data.	• Raise a deletion request • Track request status
Complaint	Report misuse or unauthorised access.	• File a grievance via app/portal • Get time-bound resolution
Opt-out	Withdraw from commercial participation.	• Turn off personalised offers • Continue core travel services

3 INTEROPERABLE ECOSYSTEM

Different systems work together — without companies replacing their existing technology or being locked into one provider.

Service Providers (Participating Partners)

- Airlines (Travel)
- Hotels (Stay)
- Retail & F&B (Shopping & Dining)
- Loyalty Partners (Rewards)
- Other Services (e.g. mobility, events)

Three Guiding Principles

- **Open Standards** — Common standards and APIs allow different companies to connect securely with DigiYatra.
- **Works with Existing Systems** — Integrates with current airline, hotel and retail systems without major changes.
- **Vendor Neutrality** — No dependence on one provider. Organisations can choose or switch providers freely.

Make systems interoperable, not identities.

DigiYatra Foundation (DYF)

Governance
Oversight
Standards
Audits

Purpose-specific Verification

- Check-in
- Lounge Access
- Retail Offers
- Loyalty Redemption
- Event Access
- ... and more

Works with existing systems | Vendor neutral | No proprietary lock-in

4 OPT-OUT MECHANISM

Optional participation. No exclusion from core journey.

Commercial Participation (Offers, Retail, Loyalty, etc.)

OFF

- ✓ Disable personalised offers and marketing
- ✓ Stop sharing data for non-essential purposes

Core Travel Services (Check-in, Security, Boarding)

ON

- ✓ Your core travel experience remains unaffected
- ✓ No digital lockout even if you opt out

You can opt out of commercial services anytime, while your core travel experience remains unaffected.

Analytical Lens Check

Applied to the DigiYatra Token Governance Model

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01

Does the proposed expansion address a genuine public need?

Convenience and luxury services are an add-on to improve passenger experience, not a core function. They let passengers access verified, quality service providers directly through the DigiYatra portal, removing the hassle of sourcing them independently. The need addressed is ease of access, not necessity.

02

Is the proposed solution necessary, or merely convenient?

Commercial services are additive, never a precondition for airport access. Loyalty programmes and personalized services (accommodation, retail, F&B) remain entirely optional, and DYF only permits expansion where a service materially improves passenger experience without compromising the core access function.

03

Could the same objectives be achieved through less intrusive alternatives?

The obvious alternative, direct data sharing between DigiYatra and third parties, risks data breaches, accountability gaps, third party misuse, and erosion of public trust. The token model is adopted instead because it minimizes data exposure by design: third parties receive only a single use, purpose bound verification signal, never raw passenger data.

04

Do the anticipated benefits justify the additional risks?

Yes. The token system delivers convenience gains without exposing passenger data, no biometric or personal information is ever shared with third parties, only a single use, purpose bound token is used throughout. This keeps residual risk low relative to the reward.

05

Under what conditions would the proposed expansion strengthen citizen welfare, public trust and ecosystem resilience?

Expansion strengthens citizen welfare, public trust, and ecosystem resilience only when: (a) participation is fully opt-in, (b) tokens are single use and purpose bound, (c) DYF remains the sole intermediary, and (d) passengers can audit their own data trail at any time.

Revocation of Participation

TRUST IS RENEWABLE, NOT PERMANENT.

The authority can withdraw an organisation's permission to participate in the DigiYatra ecosystem when it no longer meets the required conditions.

1 Purpose-Level Revocation

Disable only the non-compliant commercial use while compliant services continue.

2 Citizen-Triggered Review

Transaction-level complaints can trigger an investigation and review of the participating organisation.

3 Public Partner Status

Visible status for every organisation:

Trusted → Under Review → Restricted → Suspended → Revoked

4 Post-Revocation Obligations

Ends future ecosystem access. Organisation must complete required data deletion/ retention and resolve outstanding grievances.